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This rule also applies to personal service businesses, where, again, you generally get paid for your time. That's why lawyers, accountants, and consultants who are not yet partners in their firm—and therefore don't share in the business profits—make a moderate living at best.

Suppose you are in the pen business and you get an order for fifty thousand pens. If this were the case, what would you do? You'd simply call your supplier, order fifty thousand pens, send them off, and happily count your profits. On the other hand, suppose you are a massage therapist and you're fortunate enough to have fifty thousand people lined up outside your door all wanting a massage from you. What do you do? You kill yourself for not being in the pen business. What else can you do? Try explaining to the last person in line that you may be running "a little late," as in their appointment is Tuesday at 3:15, four decades from now!

I'm not suggesting there's anything wrong with being in a personal service business. Just don't expect to get rich anytime soon unless you create a way to duplicate or leverage yourself.

At my seminars, I often meet salaried or hourly wage employees who complain to me that they're not getting paid what they're worth. My response is "In whose opinion? I'm sure your boss thinks you're being compensated fairly. Why don't you get off the salary treadmill and ask to be paid based fully or partially on your performance? Or, if that is not possible, why not work for yourself? Then you'll know you're making exactly what you're worth." Somehow, this advice doesn't seem to appease these people, who are obviously terrified of testing their "true" value in the marketplace.

The fear most people have of being paid based on their results is often just a fear of breaking out of their old conditioning. In my experience, most people who are stuck in the steady-paycheck rut have past programming that tells them this is the "normal" way to get paid for your work.

You can't blame your parents. (I guess you can if you're a good victim.) Most parents tend to be overly protective, so it's only natural for them to want their kids to have a secure existence. As you've probably already found out, any work that doesn't provide a steady paycheck usually produces the infamous parental response "When are you going to get a real job?"